

Thursday, July 30, 2026

3:00 p.m. – General Discussion

Commissioners Ron Smith, Chair; Colene Martin, Vice-Chair; Gary Richardson; Nikole Guzman, Recorder
Additional Attendees: Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director; Matt Eide, Finance Director.

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 3:00 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest regarding the matters before the Board.

2. Human Resources

a. Replace Existing Classification to Refill Vacant Position

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, and Matt Eide, Finance Director, presented a proposal to replace the vacant, budgeted Human Resources Analyst classification with a Human Resources Risk, Safety, and ADA Coordinator classification. The Human Resources Department currently had two filled positions: the Interim Human Resources Director and a Human Resources Generalist. The proposed coordinator would fill the department's third currently budgeted position and would not increase the department's present full-time-equivalent count or adopted expenditures.

Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe explained that the proposed coordinator would be responsible for higher-risk and more complex program areas, including County risk management, workplace safety, workers' compensation, Americans with Disabilities Act coordination, employee education and training, and assistance with questions from employees and members of the public. Risk-management responsibilities had previously been handled through Legal Counsel, and the County had not maintained a dedicated risk-management position for an extended period. Establishing a dedicated resource was intended to improve consistency, reduce organizational risk, and relieve workload pressure on the existing Human Resources staff.

The Board discussed the continuing need for a Human Resources Analyst. Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe stated that the analyst classification remains essential because it supports paid-leave administration, employee benefits and health insurance, compensation and promotion changes, and other personnel processes necessary for County employees to be hired, paid, and supported. Existing staff could provide temporary coverage for those functions, but Human Resources anticipated requesting an additional analyst position through a future supplemental budget.

Mr. Eide reviewed recent Human Resources staffing levels. The department had five positions in Fiscal Year 2024-2025, four positions in Fiscal Year 2025-2026, and three positions authorized in the current budget, with only two positions presently filled. The County employed approximately 430 people, representing 400.085 full-time equivalents as of the end of June. Commissioners emphasized that filling the currently authorized vacancy would restore a budgeted position rather than expand the current County workforce.

Discussion was held regarding the supplemental-budget process. Mr. Eide explained that a supplemental budget affecting less than ten percent of an individual fund is subject to a more streamlined process, although public notice, Budget Committee involvement, and formal adoption by resolution would still be required. The Board may adjust authorized full-time-equivalent positions when the change does not increase overall appropriations. The Human Resources fund was approximately \$1 million, and the anticipated Human Resources request alone was not expected to exceed the ten-percent threshold; however, additional departmental requests could affect the scope and timeline of the supplemental budget.

Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe proposed posting the new position for approximately 12 days, reviewing applications as they were received, and attempting to complete recruitment in time for an August 24, 2026 start date. Missing that date would likely delay the next practical orientation and start date until mid-September because the

General Discussion

July 30, 2026

Page 2 of 2

following scheduled orientation period fell during the Labor Day closure. She recommended using the County's ordinary recruitment methods rather than an executive search firm. The proposed job description had been revised to include the risk, safety, workers' compensation, and ADA responsibilities that had not been consistently assigned elsewhere.

Commissioners also discussed tracking employee qualifications and maintaining current job descriptions. Human Resources maintains certifications and training records submitted by departments, while individual departments directly monitor operational requirements such as commercial driver's licenses and specialized technical credentials. The Board did not direct an immediate audit of every employee file, but supported continued review of job descriptions and qualification requirements as vacancies arise. Human Resources was also developing supervisory training to improve understanding of department leadership responsibilities and employee classifications.

Without objection, the Board authorized Human Resources to replace the vacant Human Resources Analyst classification with the Human Resources Risk, Safety, and ADA Coordinator classification and proceed with recruitment.

The Board then discussed potential items for a future supplemental budget. Chair Smith identified the need for additional support for solid-waste enforcement and Community Development code or building-permit enforcement. The Board noted that the existing solid-waste enforcement workload could not reasonably be handled by one employee and that code-enforcement concerns had been a recurring issue raised by the public. Commissioners agreed that staff should identify the specific positions that may have been omitted or reduced during the recent budget process, determine the funds affected, prepare current job descriptions, and evaluate the operational need and available funding before convening the supplemental-budget process. The Board did not intend to open the process as an unrestricted Countywide request for additional staffing because doing so could increase the cost, exceed statutory thresholds, and delay adoption. No formal action was taken regarding the supplemental budget.

3. Other

No additional matters were presented.

4. Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners/Announcements

No additional subjects or announcements were presented.

The meeting adjourned at 3:22 p.m.